

Understanding Business Communication in Today's Workplace



What Is Communication?

Communication is the process of sending and receiving messages.

BUT

Communication is ***effective*** only when –

- ❑ The message is understood and
- ❑ When it stimulates action or encourages the receiver to think in new ways.

The Changing Workplace

- ☐ Advancing technology
- ☐ The information age
- ☐ Globalization
- ☐ Workforce diversity
- ☐ Team-based organizations



Effective Communication

From: afroze.disha@bracu.ac.bd

To: bus201team@bracu.ac.bd

Subject: hey there – need ur thoughts ASAP

Everyone,

So, I'm sending this email because we have to discuss some important stuff for the project. The deadline is kinda close, but not sure when exactly – maybe next week or something? Anyway, just wanted to see what everyone is thinking about it and what needs to be done. I was also thinking we could maybe meet up? Let me know when works, I guess.

Oh, btw, some of u still haven't given me those reports from last time. Don't forget to do that when u get a chance.

Also, I think we need to finalize the budget too, but no worries for now.

Best,
Disha

Effective Communication

From: afroze.disha@bracu.ac.bd

To: bus201team@bracu.ac.bd

Subject: Urgent: Project Discussion, Deadlines, and Next Steps

Dear Team,

I hope this email finds you well. I'm writing to discuss some important updates regarding the project and to outline the next steps as we approach the deadline.

1. Project Deadline:

The project deadline is set for Friday, October 22. Please ensure that all tasks are completed by this date. If you encounter any issues that may cause delays, kindly inform me as soon as possible.

2. Pending Reports:

Several team members have yet to submit their reports from last week's meeting. Please send them to me by Wednesday, October 18, so we can review the data and proceed accordingly.



Effective Communication

3. Budget Finalization:

We also need to finalize the project budget. I'd appreciate it if the finance team could send me the updated figures by Thursday, October 19. This will allow us to stay on track financially.

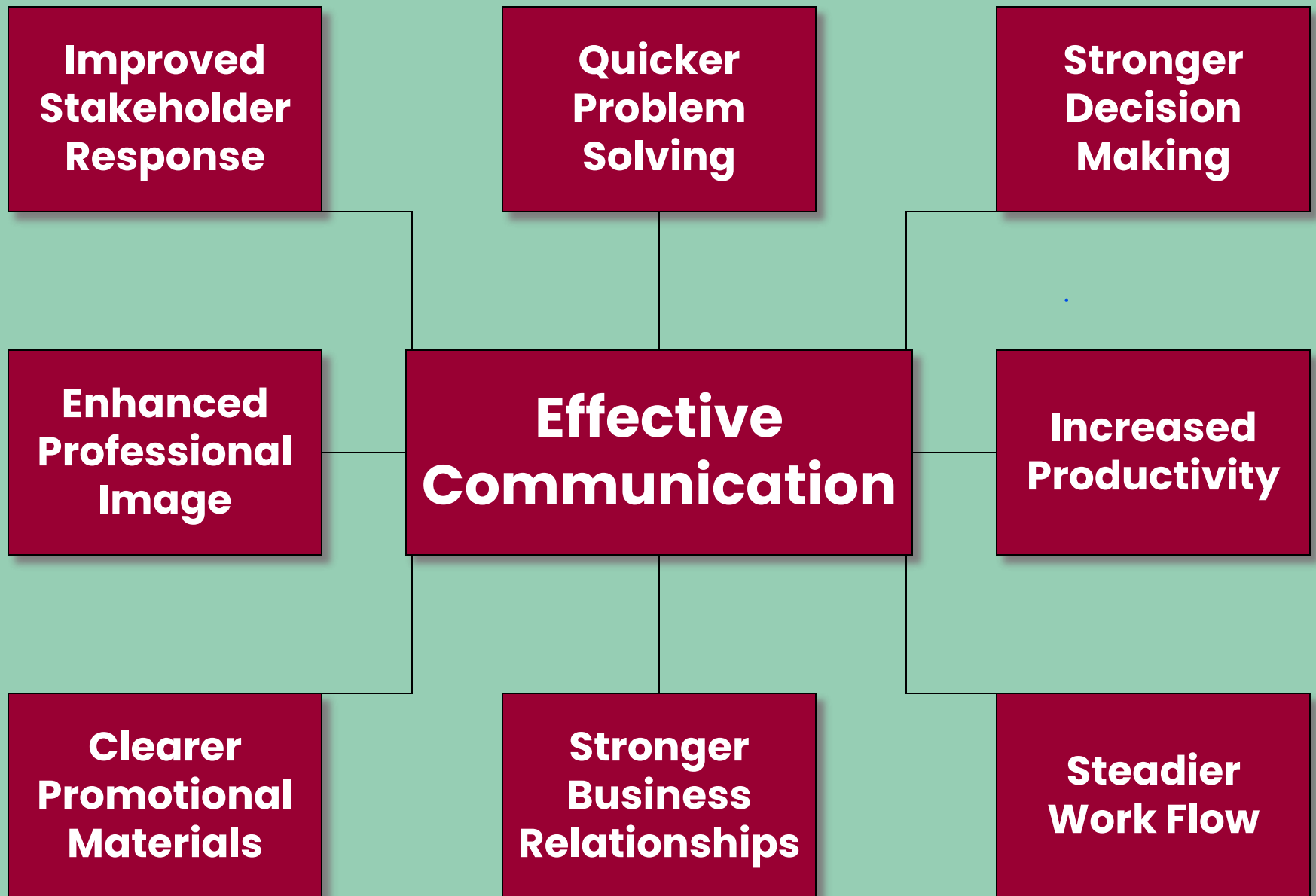
4. Team Meeting:

I suggest scheduling a brief meeting to discuss the progress and address any concerns. Please reply with your availability by the end of the day so we can arrange a suitable time.

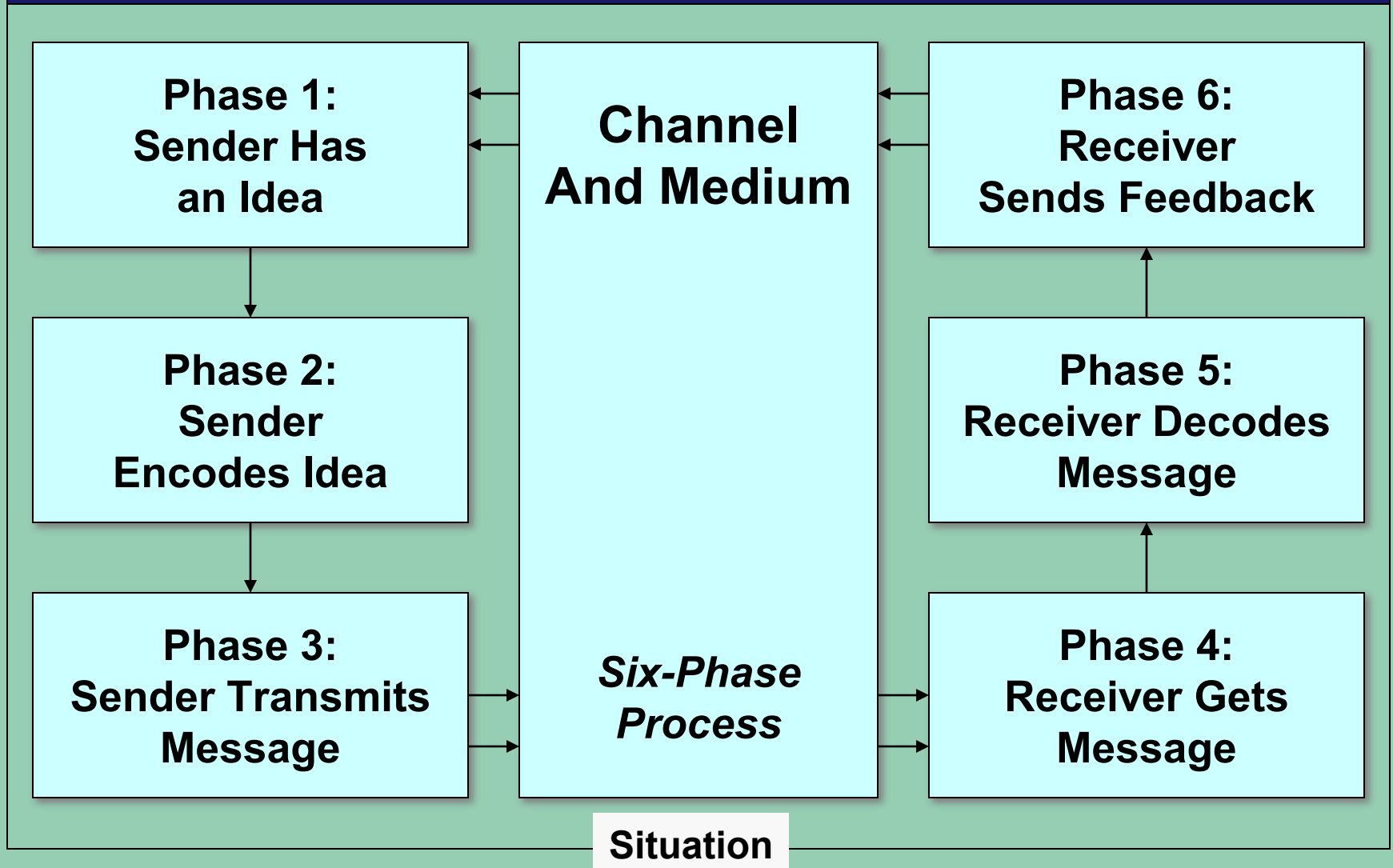
Thank you for your cooperation, and I look forward to your updates.

Best Regards,

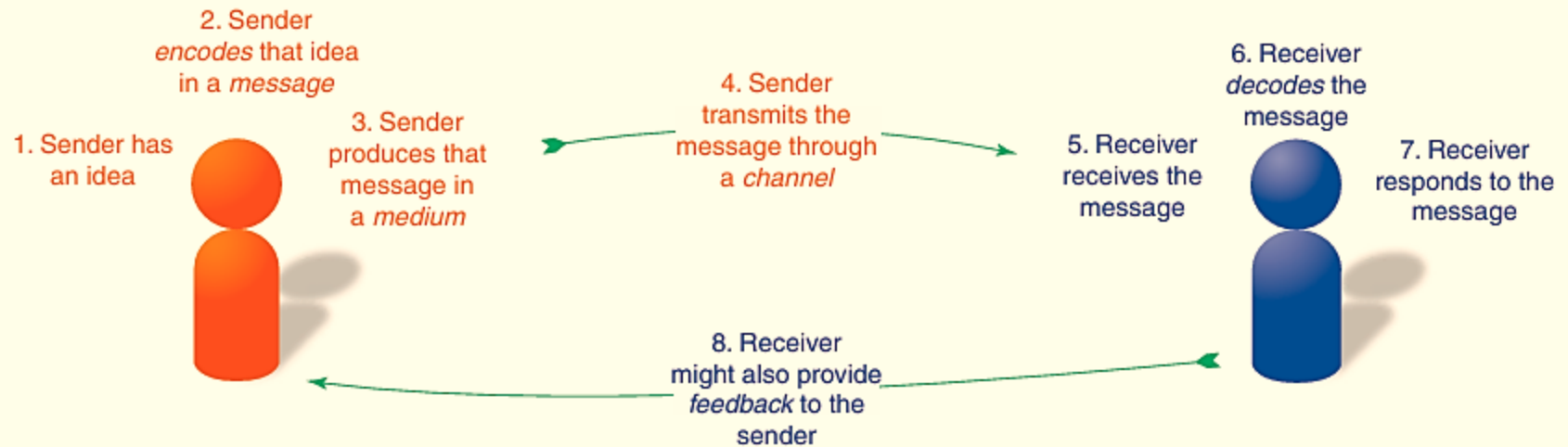
Nadia Afroze Disha
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BRAC Business School
BRAC University
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The Communication Process



The Communication Process





Improving Business Communication

- ☐ **Commit to ethical communication**
- ☐ **Adopt an audience-centered approach**
- ☐ **Develop intercultural sensitivity**
- ☐ **Improve workplace sensitivity**

Committing to **Ethical Communication**

Ethical Dilemma?

Alternatives

Unclear

Ambiguous

Ethical Lapse?

Choice

Illegal

Unethical

Example!

RESTAURANT PREP TIME	ADVERTISING PREP TIME
APPROX 3 MINS TO ASSEMBLE BY OUR DEDICATED CREW	APPROX 4 HOURS WITH HELP FROM: LIGHTING FOOD STYLIST PHOTOGRAPHER EDITING PHOTOSHOP



Making Ethical Choices

- ☐ Is this message legal?
- ☐ Is this message balanced?
- ☐ Can you live with this message?
- ☐ Is this message feasible?

Audience-Centered Communication

Biases

Education

Age

Status

Style



Improving Intercultural Sensitivity

- ☐ Recognize cultural differences
- ☐ Overcome ethnocentrism
- ☐ Polish written intercultural skills
- ☐ Develop oral communication skills



Recognizing Cultural Differences

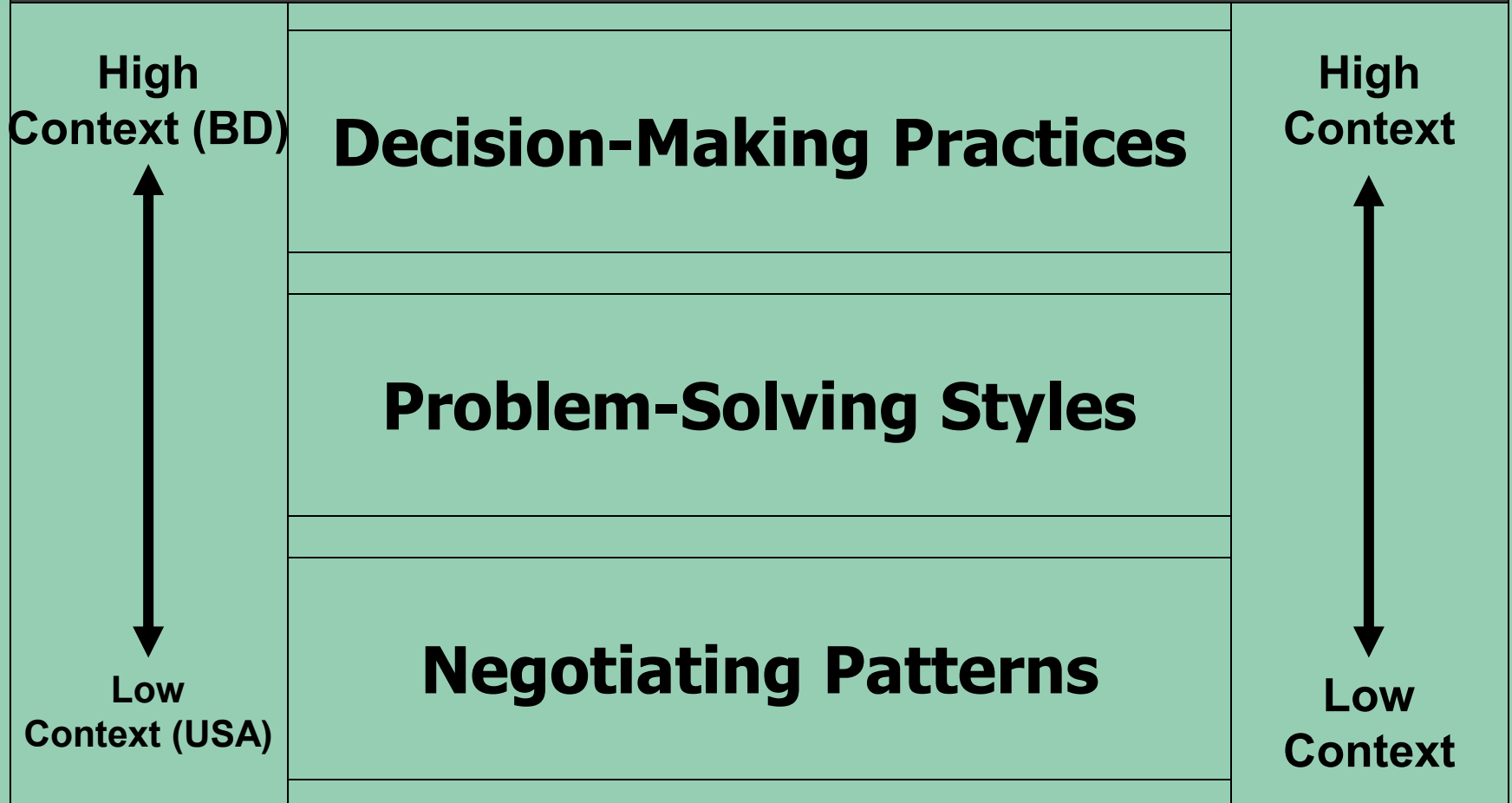
Context

Ethics

**Social
Customs**

**Nonverbal
Communication**

Cultural Context



Legal and Ethical Behavior

- ❑ **Cultural context** also influences legal and ethical behavior.
- ❑ For example, because low-context cultures value the written word, written agreements are binding.
- ❑ High-context cultures put less emphasis on the written word and consider personal pledges more important than contracts. They also tend to view law with flexibility; low-context cultures value the letter of the law.
- ❑ As you conduct business around the world, you'll find that legal systems differ from culture to culture. These differences can be particularly important if your firm must communicate about a legal dispute in another country



High Context Culture

Legal and Ethical Behavior

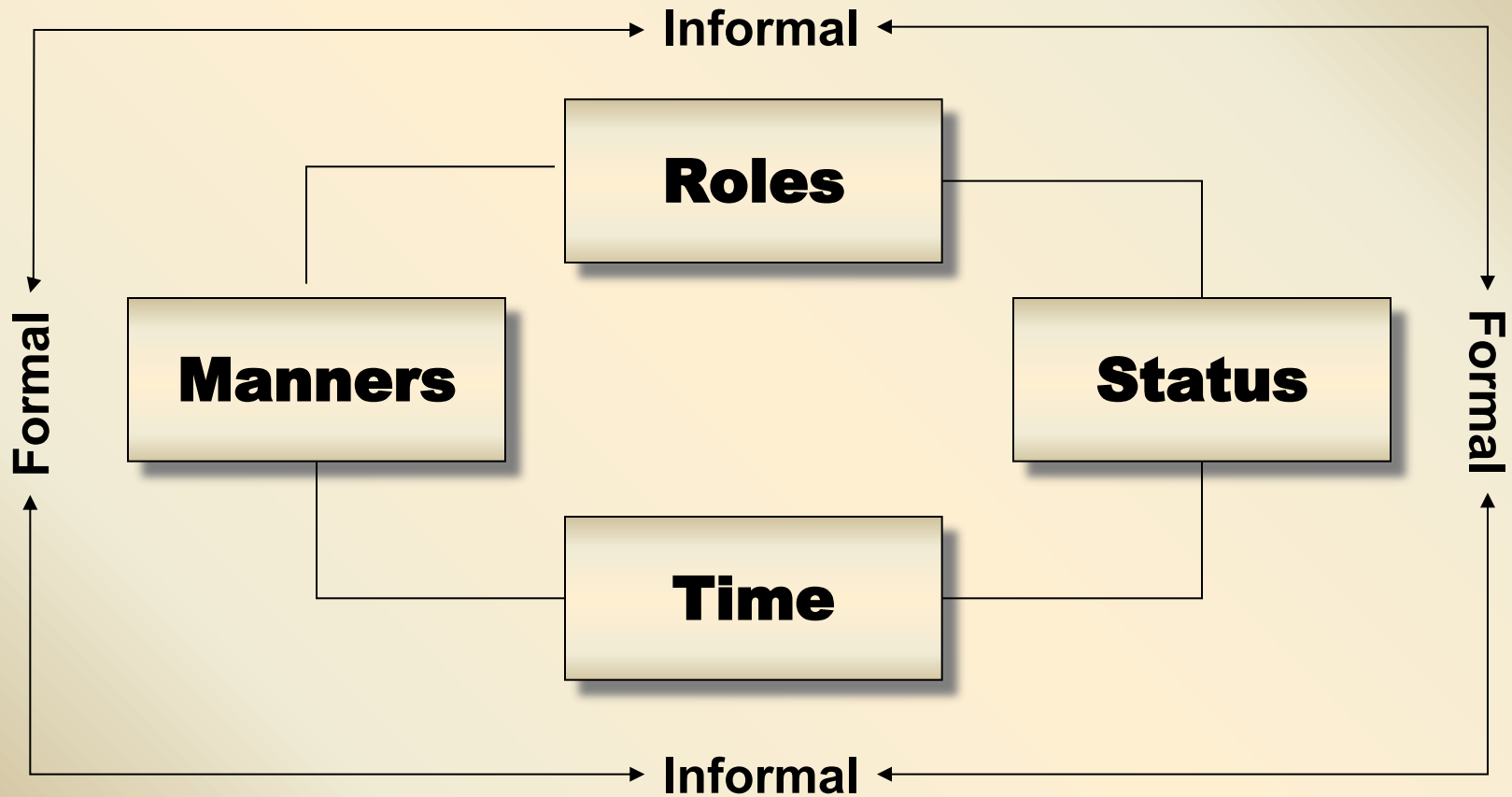
Seek Mutual Ground (Think Win-Win!)

Withhold Judgment

Send Honest Messages

Respect Cultural Differences

Social Customs



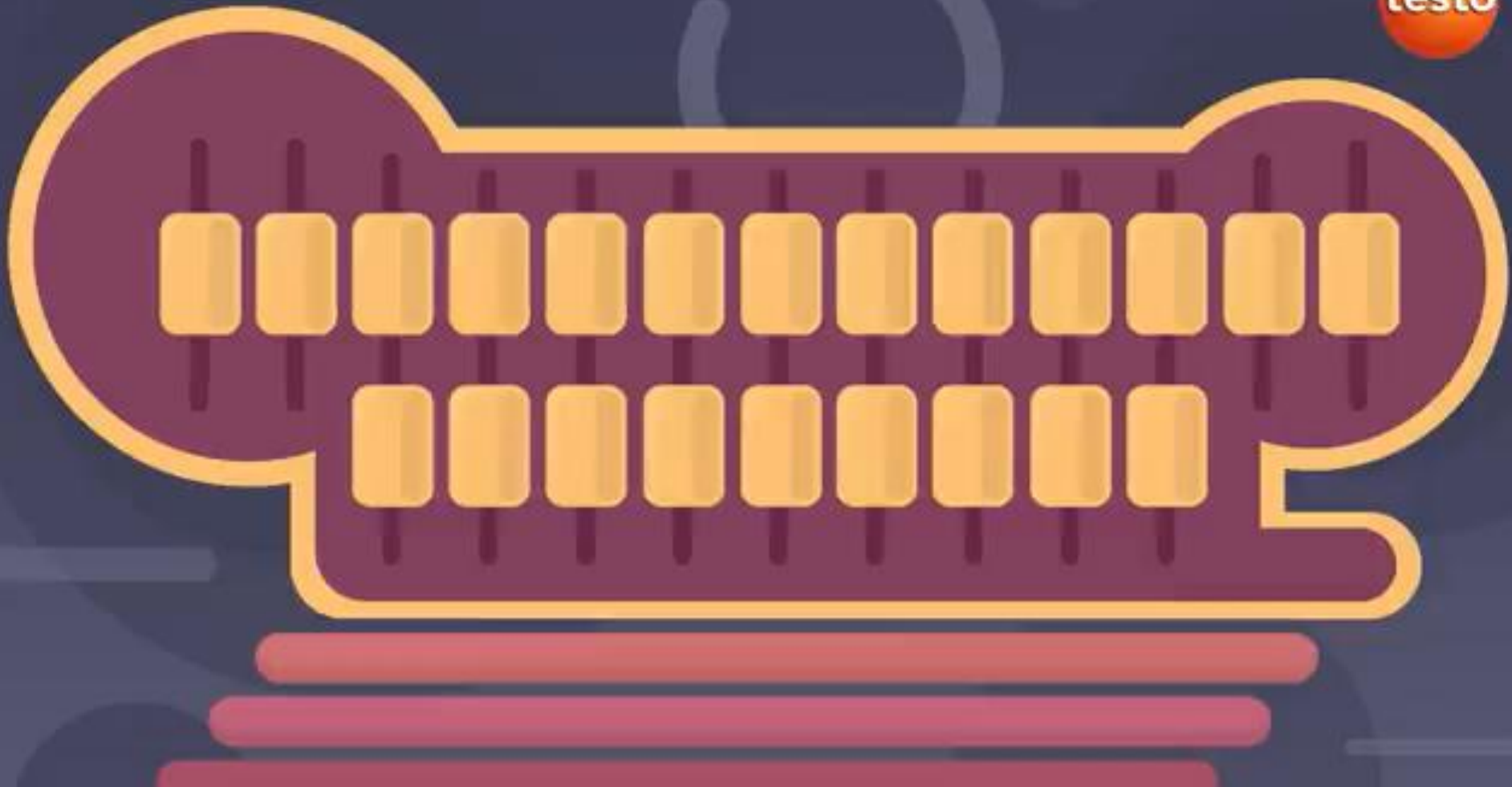
Nonverbal Communication



Body Language



Personal Space



Overcoming Ethnocentrism



- ☐ **Accept Distinctions**
- ☐ **Avoid Assumptions**
- ☐ **Avoid Judgments**

Written Intercultural Skills



- Use plain English
- Be clear
- Avoid slang and idioms
- Write short paragraphs

Written Intercultural Skills



- Be brief
- Use transitions (Like: However, therefore, etc.)
- Use proper addresses (US, Korea, Japan differences!)
- Cite numbers carefully

Oral Intercultural Skills

(Recommended: Look at Julian treasure Ted Talk video!)

**Minimize
Noise**

**Obtain
Feedback**

**Speak
Slowly**

**Clarify
Intent**

**Do Not
Talk Down**

**Be
Accurate**

Oral Intercultural Skills

**Learn Foreign
Phrases**

**Listen
Carefully**

**Adapt
Your Style**

**Check for
Understanding**

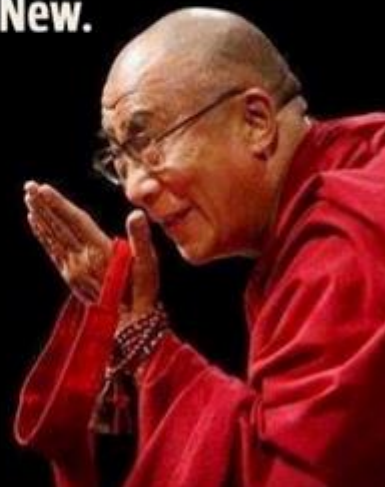
**Clarify the
Next Step**

**Watch Body
Language**

Listen carefully!

**When You Talk, You Are Only
Repeating What You Already Know.
But If You Listen, You May
Learn Something New.**

~ Dalai Lama



Improving Workplace Sensitivity

- ☐ **Assume differences**
- ☐ **Take responsibility**
- ☐ **Withhold judgment**
- ☐ **Be respectful**
- ☐ **Show empathy**
- ☐ **Tolerate ambiguity**



Improving Workplace Sensitivity

- ☐ **Look past the superficial**
- ☐ **Be patient**
- ☐ **Be persistent**
- ☐ **Admit cultural biases**
- ☐ **Stay flexible**



Improving Workplace Sensitivity

- ☐ Find common ground
- ☐ Send clear messages
- ☐ Deal with individuals
- ☐ Learn when to be direct
- ☐ Test your understanding



Practice Question

From: afroze.disha@bracu.ac.bd

To: bus201team@bracu.ac.bd

Subject: hi :)

Hey,

I just wanted to talk to u about that project we're working on. So, there's been some stuff happening, and I'm not really sure about all the details but thought u should know. Anyways, I guess u can figure it out? It'd be cool if u could send me what u have so far because we have to present to the big boss guy, Mr. Henry, next week or something. Hope it goes well, lol.

Also, I think I'll be on a break next week for a few days. No worries, though – u can probably handle things, right? Let me know if you get stuck or anything. I'm around...ish.

Cheers,
Disha :)

Thanks!

Do you have any questions?

CONSULTATION HOURS

Sunday and Tuesday

8:00 AM – 9:30 AM, 12:20 PM – 1:30 PM

Monday

10:50 AM – 1:30 PM

Wednesday

10:50 AM – 2:50 PM

COMMUNICATION

Office: C-26, Level 5, BRACU New Campus

Email: afroze.disha@bracu.ac.bd